

Small intestine

With help from the gall bladder and pancreas, the small intestine completes digestion, using enzymes. These chemical digesters break down the proteins, carbohydrates, and fats in foods into simple nutrients that are absorbed into the bloodstream.

Small intestine

The small intestine is nearly 23 ft (7 m) long and has three sections. The shortest is the duodenum. The middle jejunum and final ileum are where most digestion and absorption take place.

The **large intestine** lies in front of the duodenum

Jejunum

Ileum

Extra help

Two liquids kick-start digestion in the small intestine. Bile turns fats into tiny droplets that are easier to break down. Pancreatic juice contains enzymes that digest proteins and carbohydrates.

The **gall bladder** stores bile made in the liver

Bile duct carries bile toward the duodenum

Pancreatic duct carries pancreatic juice toward the duodenum

Opening of bile and pancreatic ducts into the duodenum

Pancreas makes pancreatic juice

